

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 656

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dr. Yoo Keun "Tom" Kim
of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Dr. Yoo Keun "Tom"
Kim of Knoxville, founder of the Kim Health Center; and

WHEREAS, an iconic doctor, businessman, and philanthropist, Dr. Kim was passionate
about his work with his patients, deeply understanding that it was his joy and privilege to provide
life-saving medical care to countless individuals; and

WHEREAS, as a child, Dr. Kim escaped the Korean War with his family, moving from
North Korea to South Korea and then to the United States; in 1993, he founded the Free
Medical Clinic of America as a Christian ministry, reflecting his deep faith in Jesus Christ and his
lifelong mission of service; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Kim helped establish three free medical clinics across East Tennessee,
providing compassionate care to those most in need; throughout his career, he helped more
than 16,000 patients in the Knoxville area; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Kim was known as a true "Renaissance doctor," placing no limits on
service when health and safety were at stake; his vision, tireless work ethic, and unwavering
commitment inspired a dedicated community of volunteer physicians and healthcare
professionals who shared his mission to ensure access to care for low income and uninsured
individuals; and

WHEREAS, a man of abiding faith, Dr. Kim was a devoted member of Cedar Springs
Presbyterian Church; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Kim was deeply devoted to his family, and he was committed to family
values of the highest manner; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his beloved wife, Hwa Ok Kim; children, Kimberly Kim (David Chapman) and Timothy Kim (Emma Hassall); granddaughter, Elaine Chapman; and siblings, Sae Keun and Hae Keun Kim; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by Soon Bin Kim, Bong Oh Kim, Hyun Sook Kim, Hyun Keun Kim, and Yong Keun Kim; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Kim leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Dr. Yoo Keun "Tom" Kim, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Dr. Kim.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.